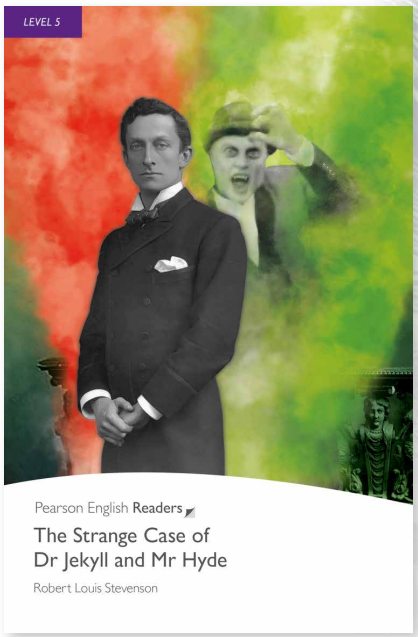
DR JEKYLL & MR HYDE by Robert Louis Stevenson (B1+–B2+)



PREPARATION

1 **Answer the questions.**

see

1 What does this picture represent?



think

2 Do you think everyone has the potential to be a good and a bad person?

3 What stops people doing bad things?

wonder

4 Would you do something bad if you knew you wouldn't get caught? Why/Why not?

I become Mr Hyde

I waited for a long time before I tested this idea in an experiment. I knew that I risked death. I wanted to change my body, but if I took too much of a drug that so powerfully controlled my inner nature, it might completely destroy me. But the thought of such a powerful discovery at last made me overcome my fears. I had already prepared the liquid; I now bought a large quantity of a particular salt from a chemist. I knew, from my experiments, this salt was the one thing still needed. And late one night I mixed the drugs. I watched them boil and steam in a glass, and, with a **burst** of courage, I swallowed the mixture. The most terrible pains followed: I experienced aching bones, violent sickness, and a sense of horror that cannot be worse at the hour of birth or death. Then these pains quickly began to pass, and I recovered as if I had been suffering from a serious illness. I felt something strange in my blood, something **indescribably** new, **unbelievably** sweet. I felt younger, lighter and happier in body; in my mind, I was **conscious** of a **wild** current of **disordered fancies** and of an unknown and slightly evil freedom of the soul. I knew, at the first breath of this new life, that I was the slave of my original evil, but much worse, ten times worse; and the thought of this strengthened and pleased me like wine. I stretched out my hands, taking pleasure in these new feelings, and as I did I suddenly realised that I had lost height. There was no mirror in my study at that time. I was filled with hope and with the pride of success so I decided to go out in my new shape as far as my bedroom. I crossed the **yard**; I walked softly along the passages, a stranger in my own house. When I arrived at my room I saw for the first time the appearance of Edward Hyde.



GLOSSARY

burst *n.* a strong and sudden feeling
indescribably *adv.* impossible to describe
unbelievably *adv.* impossible to believe
to be conscious of *adj.* to be aware of
wild *adj.* very exciting
disordered *adj.* not organised or rational
fancy *n.* a wish, want or desire
yard *n.* an area like a garden outside a house

COMPREHENSION

2 LL9.01 **Listen and read the text. Write short answers to the questions using no more than three words.**

1 What was the biggest risk of taking the drug? .....
2 What was the last thing he added to the mixture? .....
3 What did he experience as soon as he swallowed the mixture? .....
4 How did he feel physically after that? .....
5 How did he feel about his new evil state? .....
6 How was his appearance different when he became Mr Hyde? .....

LISTENING

3 LL9.02 **Listen to more of how Dr Jekyll felt as Mr Hyde. What does he plan to do as Mr Hyde that he couldn't do as the respectable Dr Jekyll?**

GLOSSARY

respectability *n.* the quality of being respectable
unrecognisable *adj.* impossible to recognise

ACTIVE INVESTIGATION

4A Language is full of words and expressions that come from literature. What do we mean when we describe a person as 'a Jekyll and Hyde character'?

B Find out more about these words from literature. Translate them into Italian if you want to. What books, poems, or plays do they come from? What do they mean?

1 quixotic *adj.*
2 utopia *n.*
3 pandemonium *n.*
4 mentor *n.*
5 robot *n.*

CLIL CONNECTION
Science

5 Dr Jekyll uses science to do something dangerous and immoral. Find out when these scientific advances were made and which scientists were part of the work.

1 antibiotics
2 Artificial Intelligence (AI)
3 nuclear power

SPEAKING

6 Work with a partner. What are the benefits and dangers to society of these scientific discoveries?

